

United Overseas Bank (UOB)

First Take: Mixed quarter, meets Street, beats JPMe

Our First Take: Numerically, UOB beat 1Q26 JPMe by 5%. Our full-year estimates are 6% below Bloomberg consensus (qtrly is thin), which suggests at best, an in-line set of results. Yet, given the high bar set by DBS 1Q26 ([link](#)), we believe these numbers may not be a driver for the stock in either direction. UOB declared 1Q26 profits of S\$1,437mn, up 2% q/q, and down 4% y/y. NII was down only 1% q/q, with NIM compression arrested at -2bps q/q to 1.82%. Treasury income (non-flow) was quite firm, up \$150mn q/q to \$364mn (19% of PPOP), which in our view deserves lower multiples vs. most other business lines. Fee growth was weak at 2% q/q despite seasonality, and down 8% y/y. This is an important contrast to DBS (up 35%/16% q/q and y/y), and we expect trends to hold well at OCBC too. We worry that the weaker WM franchise at UOB could continue to be a drag on fees for a few quarters. Cost control was quite good, down 2% y/y, and was the main driver of the PPOP beat. NPLs were slightly better at 1.5% with credit costs at 24bps, a beat vs. our forecasts. Greater China AQ continues to weaken (3.5% NPL, up ~20bps q/q) with lower coverage of 57% (vs. 60% last Q). That said, US portfolio quality improved significantly, in line with guidance last quarter (NPLs halved q/q to 1.5% with coverage at 233%). CET1 ratio improved 30bps q/q to 15.2%. Overall, key trends are in-line NII, weak fees, better costs and AQ. The stock appears cheap at 11.4x/1.2x 2026E PE/PB for 10.7% RoE. Yet, we do not see these numbers creating conditions for re-rating, especially as peers are delivering much better fee/WM growth. We continue to prefer DBS and SGX in the sector.

Key Positives

NII held up better than expected, with NIM down 2bps q/q to 1.82% as the funding cost decline largely offset asset re-pricing. New NPA formation trend improved, with S\$341mn new NPAs (~10bps of loans vs. 17bps average in last 4 quarters).

Key Negatives/Question Marks

Fee income was weaker than expected and down y/y, due to weaker loan/trade-related income. WM fee growth was muted (below 3%) with net new money at S\$1bn.

Likely Changes to Consensus

We expect limited changes from the Street post results.

Expected Stock Reaction

We expect a limited stock price reaction.

See page 4 for analyst certification and important disclosures, including non-US analyst disclosures.

Underweight

UOBH.SI, UOB SP

Price (06 May 26): S\$36.65

Price Target (Jun-27): S\$33.00



APAC Banks

Harsh Wardhan Modi ^{AC}

(65) 6882-2450

harsh.w.modi@jpmorgan.com

J.P. Morgan Securities Singapore Private Limited/
J.P. Morgan Securities (Asia Pacific) Limited/ J.P.
Morgan Broking (Hong Kong) Limited

Daniel Andrew Tan, CFA

(63-2) 8554-2413

danielandrew.o.tan@jpmorgan.com

J.P. Morgan Securities Philippines, Inc.

Conference Call Details

UOB is hosting a media briefing at 9am SGT and an analyst briefing at 10:15am SGT today.

Table 1: UOB: 1Q26 earnings review

P&L (\$mn)	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26A	1Q26E	YoY	QoQ	JPM
Net Interest Income	2,409	2,336	2,265	2,346	2,324	2,293	-4%	-1%	1%
Non-Interest Income	1,248	1,129	1,133	944	1,099	1,202	-12%	16%	-9%
Fee Income	694	636	615	625	637	702	-8%	2%	-9%
Other Non-Il	554	493	518	319	462	500	-17%	45%	-8%
Operating Revenue	3,657	3,465	3,398	3,289	3,423	3,495	-6%	4%	-2%
Operating Costs	(1,559)	(1,535)	(1,535)	(1,528)	(1,523)	(1,588)	-2%	0%	-4%
PPOP	2,097	1,930	1,863	1,761	1,900	1,907	-9%	8%	0%
Impairment Charge	(297)	(288)	(1,368)	(120)	(210)	(283)	-29%	75%	-26%
Other Income	22	(3)	25	35	23	23	5%	-34%	1%
Pre-Tax	1,822	1,639	520	1,677	1,712	1,646	-6%	2%	4%
Net profit	1,490	1,338	443	1,410	1,437	1,363	-4%	2%	5%
DPS (\$)	-	1.10	-	0.71	-	-	NM	-100%	NM
Gross Loans	341,154	342,900	351,084	352,180	353,837	354,312	4%	0%	0%
Deposits	401,250	405,076	419,660	425,938	426,731	430,777	6%	0%	-1%
NPL	5,458	5,341	5,617	5,379	5,308	5,555	-3%	-1%	-4%
NPA	5,361	5,386	5,809	5,440	5,276	5,616	-2%	-3%	-6%
Total Allowances	4,829	4,765	5,787	5,268	5,251	5,398	9%	0%	-3%
							Change in bps		
NIM	2.00%	1.91%	1.82%	1.84%	1.82%	1.80%	(18)	(2)	2
CIR	42.6%	44.3%	45.2%	46.5%	44.5%	45.4%	186	(196)	(95)
LDR	85.0%	84.7%	83.7%	82.7%	82.9%	82.2%	(210)	23	67
CASA Ratio	55.1%	56.5%	57.0%	58.4%	57.0%	58.4%	190	(137)	(143)
Credit Costs (bps)	34	32	134	19	24	32	(10)	4	(8)
NPL Ratio	1.60%	1.56%	1.60%	1.53%	1.50%	1.57%	(10)	(3)	(7)
NPA Coverage	90%	88%	100%	97%	100%	96%	1,000	300	375
CET1 (fully phased-in)	15.4%	15.2%	14.5%	14.9%	15.2%	14.8%	(23)	30	41

Source: Company reports, J.P. Morgan estimates.

Table 2: UOB 2026 Guidance vs. JPM

	UOB Guidance	JPM
Loan growth	Low single digit	2.7%
NIM	1.75-1.80%	1.77%
Fee growth	High single digit	7.0%
Operating cost growth	Low single digit	2.8%
Total credit costs	25-30bps	37bps

Source: Company reports, J.P. Morgan estimates.

Investment Thesis, Valuation and Risks

United Overseas Bank (UOB) *(Underweight; Price Target: S\$33.00)*

Investment Thesis

We are UW on UOB.

- UOB has delivered RoE with the least volatility among Singapore banks over the past 20 years. This may change over the next few quarters, as asset quality risks could remain elevated.
- The bank has lagged peers on WM (limited organic and inorganic build in last 15Y), as well on USD-denominated payment/deposits (26% at UOB vs. 40%/34% at DBS/OCBC). These factors, amongst others, likely led the bank to take too much risk in areas linked to property in Asia and the US over the last decade in a bid to generate better returns. Accordingly, we are now witnessing an increase in credit risks. The timing of gross NPL formation, recoveries and upgrades, as well as evolution of collateral values should lead to volatility on credit costs and expectations thereof.
- The bank has committed to a 50% payout ratio for regular dividends. Hence, as EPS risk increases, DPS will be at risk as well. This could limit the upside for the stock.
- We expect ROE to be closer to 11% in 1H26 vs. 12-13% in 4Q24/1Q25. We expect the stock to offer a more balanced risk-return trade-off closer to the mean of 1-1.1 fwd PB; which would price in a degree of lingering AQ risks.
- Following increased spend in the last 2Y, the bank is better positioned to focus on efficiency, which could pose an upside risk.

Valuation

Our Jun-27 PT of S\$33 is based on a fair P/B of 1.03x with a normalized RoE of 11%, a risk-free rate of 4.15%, a cost of capital of 11% and a growth rate of 4.1%.

Risks to Rating and Price Target

Upside risks include better-than-expected delivery on AQ, with sustained normalization of NPA formation and credit costs. On PPoP, the bank's ability to manage wins from its digital investments could lead to positive revisions, and investments coming to fruition earlier than anticipated would pose upside risks to costs.

Downside catalysts include credit cost increases, growth and NIM disappointments, and lower-than-expected dividends and buybacks. Higher operating costs would also be a downside risk. Higher-than-anticipated digital investment spending could be a drag on profitability.

Companies Discussed in This Report (all prices in this report as of market close on 06 May 2026, unless otherwise indicated)
DBS Group Holdings(DBSM.SI/SS\$58.85/OW), Singapore Exchange(SGXL.SI/SS\$21.39/OW)

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United Overseas Bank (UOB) (UOBH.SI, UOB SP) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (\$S)	Price Target (\$S)
05-Oct-23	N	28.07	28
09-Dec-23	N	27.58	27
13-Mar-24	N	28.28	30
03-Jul-24	N	31.65	32.5
06-Oct-24	N	31.86	34
10-Nov-24	OW	35.69	41
14-Jan-25	OW	36.80	43
23-Mar-25	N	37.95	40
21-May-25	N	35.40	37
13-Jul-25	N	36.86	38
08-Aug-25	N	35.81	36.5
10-Sep-25	UW	35.57	32.5
28-Nov-25	N	33.89	34
25-Jan-26	UW	39.50	34
17-Apr-26	UW	37.52	33

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Sep 24, 2002. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

DBS Group Holdings (DBSM.SI, DBS SP) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (\$S)	Price Target (\$S)
05-Oct-23	UW	30.20	28
09-Dec-23	UW	28.73	27.5
13-Mar-24	N	30.46	30
03-Jul-24	OW	37.10	41
06-Oct-24	OW	38.04	42
10-Nov-24	OW	42.40	50
11-Feb-25	OW	45.38	51
23-Mar-25	OW	45.31	49
21-May-25	N	44.38	47
13-Jul-25	N	45.99	48
08-Aug-25	N	49.75	50.5
10-Sep-25	OW	50.88	56
28-Nov-25	OW	54.00	70
03-Apr-26	OW	57.55	63
17-Apr-26	OW	57.30	62
07-May-26	OW	58.85	64

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Dec 11, 2001. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

Singapore Exchange (SGXL.SI, SGX SP) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (\$S)	Price Target (\$S)
29-Nov-23	N	9.39	10
20-May-24	OW	9.24	10.5
22-Aug-24	N	10.60	10.5
12-Sep-24	UW	11.76	10.5
06-Oct-24	UW	11.68	11
28-Jan-25	UW	12.23	11.1
13-Feb-25	UW	13.66	11
09-Apr-25	N	12.02	11
27-Apr-25	UW	14.36	12.8
16-Jul-25	UW	15.67	14
10-Sep-25	N	16.35	16
28-Nov-25	OW	16.60	18.5
03-Feb-26	OW	17.56	19
24-Feb-26	OW	17.97	20
03-Apr-26	OW	20.00	22
17-Apr-26	OW	21.18	24

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
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